

AVA S. ORTOLANO

Clarence Center, NY | avaortolano@outlook.com | (716) 730-1044

EDUCATION

Michigan State University, College of Communications | East Lansing, MI
Bachelor of Arts in Advertising Management | Minors: Business & Public Relations
• GPA: 3.6

May 2026

Education Abroad Program | Rome, Italy

Summer 2025

- Completed international coursework while studying abroad in Rome
- Strengthened cross-cultural communication and global perspective

WORK EXPERIENCE

WNY Women's Foundation | Buffalo, NY

April 2026 – Present

Event & Advertising Intern

- Served as a lead coordinator for the Foundation's Leadership Summit, overseeing planning and on-site execution for a nonprofit conference with 1,000+ attendees
- Managed end-to-end event logistics including vendor coordination, venue walkthroughs, catering and supply procurement, room setup, signage, registration support, and event-day operations
- Collaborated with executive leadership, sponsors, speakers, and community partners to ensure seamless event execution and a high-quality attendee experience
- Created digital and print marketing materials, event collateral, promotional campaigns, and branded communications to increase event awareness and community engagement
- Hosted the Foundation's livestream, conducted interviews, and represented the organization while engaging with executives, sponsors, keynote speakers, and community leaders
- Coordinated speaker and VIP logistics, monitored event timelines, and quickly resolved day-of operational challenges across multiple event spaces
- Supported fundraising and donor engagement initiatives by developing marketing assets and communications for campaigns including Give 716, helping strengthen community outreach and donor participation
- Produced post-event content including social media assets, recap materials, and promotional content to extend audience engagement beyond the event
- Worked cross-functionally with Foundation leadership to manage project timelines, prioritize competing deadlines, and execute multiple initiatives simultaneously in a fast-paced environment
- Exceeded ticket sales goal by \$12K through outreach and relationship building with local businesses and donors, converting conversations into event support

Chi Omega Sorority | East Lansing, MI

December 2023 – December 2024

Social Events Coordinator

- Planned and executed events for a 300-member organization
- Managed vendor communication, inventory tracking, budgeting, and event logistics using Excel
- Increased member engagement through creative social programming and event coordination

JusCollege | East Lansing, MI

April 2023 – May 2026

Campus Director

- Led marketing and event coordination for MSU's Las Vegas trip serving 500+ students
- Recruited and managed campus representatives responsible for promotional outreach
- Collaborated with leadership teams to coordinate timelines, communication, and logistics

CERTIFICATIONS

HubSpot Digital Marketing Certification – HubSpot Academy

SKILLS

Technical: Microsoft Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Canva, Google Analytics,

Social Media: Instagram, TikTok, LinkedIn, Facebook

Professional: Event Planning, Public Relations, Livestream Hosting, Vendor Coordination, Public Speaking
Partnership & sponsor relations, Marketing, Public speaking, Project management, Nonprofit fundraising, Crisis
management, Community engagement

AI & Productivity: ChatGPT, Claude, Microsoft Copilot, AI-assisted research, prompt engineering, content
creation, website design